OPEN ITEMS CHECKLIST — part 8 (30 October 2026)

Changes since part 7 (28 October 2026). Stage 6i gives `HEADER` a dictionary entry, adds `SMUDGE`, and splits the largest unit-test group. Source: `forth6809_stage_6i.asm`, `unit_tests.asm`; documentation: `ClaudeForth 20261030`. The shadow file is unchanged (`forth6809 20261027.shd`): no comment was moved out of the new code.

HEADER and SMUDGE (stage 6i)

- ☑ **`HEADER` (smudge-flag "name" --)** is now a word. The routine was already complete and stack-clean; only a header was needed (11 bytes). A true flag sets the smudge bit, so the word is hidden until `SMUDGE`.
- ☑ **`SMUDGE` (--)** toggles bit 6 of the header `LATEST` names (9 bytes of code, an 11-byte header). Calling it twice restores the header.
- ☑ Both headers sit at the tail of the FORTH chain, directly after the ROOT headers in `BASEDICT`: `H_HEADER` links to `BASEROOTLATEST`, `H_SMUDGE` to `H_HEADER`, and `H_BRTHEN` to `H_SMUDGE`. The words are not in ROOT. ROM words: 262 (247 FORTH, 15 ROOT).
- ☑ **ROM layout.** `BASEDICT` `$CFA3`, `BASECODE` `$D952` (both `$20` lower). `BASEDICT` 2479 bytes; `BASECODE` 9487 polled (`$D952` - `$FE60`), 9806 interrupt-driven (`$D952` - `$FF9F`); padding below `INITCODE`: 323 bytes polled, **4 bytes interrupt-driven**. Spare ROM below `BASEDICT` 3747 bytes.
- ☑ **ANS test file `34_header_smudge.tests.fs`**, 15 tests. It defines `CODE` and `END-CODE` from the two words (including the `ALSO <vocabulary>` order) and runs a CODE word. Passes. 33 (76), 12 (73) and 8 (71) still pass.
- ☑ **Unit tests `TSTHEADER` and `TSTSMUDGE`** in group 19 (DefWords part 2). Group 19 now ends at `$CC7C`.
- ☑ **Unit test group 9 split** (it would not fit once `BASEDICT` moved down): group 9 keeps `IMMEDIATE` to `POSTPONE`; the new **group 20** has `[COMPILE]`, `>BODY`, `EXECUTE`, `SLITERAL` and `ABORT"`. Both print under the "CompWords" heading. Group 9 ends `$CAB4`, group 20 `$C8A2`. Selectors now run 0 to 20.
- ☑ Largest groups now: group 11 (`$CEA6`, 253 bytes spare), group 10 (`$CE9D`,

262 spare), group 4 (`$CE2B`), group 7 (`$CE10`).

- ☑ Documentation: glossary entries (3.9), new Section 4.7 (building CODE and END-CODE; note the order `ALSO ASSEMBLER` , not `ASSEMBLER ALSO`), memory-map figures, selector table (20), Section 5 item, 262 words.

Open items

- ☐ **Scripts:** `run all tests.sh` and `build all tests.sh` need selectors 19 and 20 added (loop bound 21 and two names in `SECTION_NAMES` , for example `"3.9_DefWords2" "3.10_CompWords2"` after `"3.12_StrParse2"`). If 18 is also missing in your copy, add `"3.12_StrParse2"` as well, in selector order.
- ☐ **Runner:** add `34` to the `--sections` list (README, README_ANS.md).
- ☐ **Interrupt-driven headroom is 4 bytes** (part 7 had 3). The next addition of even a few bytes needs the same remedy again: lower `BASECODE` / `BASEDICT` , which takes space from the unit-test region (group 11 has 253 bytes spare).
- ☐ **Not run here:** MAME, and the interrupt-driven (SERIALPOLL=0) unit tests. Assembly of every group was checked for both serial modes; the groups were run in the emulator in the polled build only. Please confirm `run all tests.sh` for both `--serialpoll` values, 0 to 20.
- ☐ `HEADER` does not check the name length: a name over 31 characters corrupts the flag bits of the length byte (the same applies to `:` and `CREATE` ; see the older item on `WORD` 's cap). A CODE word with a long name would be caught only by the assembler's own checks.
- ☐ Items still open from part 7 apply (ENVIRONMENT? `SEARCH-ORDER` queries; no assembler unit-test group for the Search-Order words; README edits).
- ☐ Part 7's note on the 6 spare bytes in group 9 and the 3-byte headroom is superseded by this part.